

	UK↓	USA↓	Torrent	RAM (Mb)
	10.56	8.13	1	134
	10.28	5.3	10.2	98.9
	11.69	9.9	2.5	80.7
	12.27	7.08	10.3	225.7
	13.2	9.47	2.4	213.4
	13.5	9.52	2.1	223.9
	12.86	6.88	4.9	133.9
	9.74	5.31	0.79	65.6
	14.18	8.74	9.9	92.7
	12.9	15.4	3.8	-

vate Internet Access added a live chat feature for support, where previously email was the only option available.

PureVPN



PureVPN is a minimalist app that still keeps all the relevant control options one or two clicks away from the

main interface. The UI of the Windows client is exactly like the Windows 10 UI, which makes navigating the controls and options of the app incredibly intuitive.

PureVPN is based in the Virgin Islands, which is a safe location for a VPN service, and publishes a transparency report. With support for a killswitch, static IP addresses, and IP tunneling, PureVPN scores high on the privacy front. The service is based in Hong Kong and was founded by a Pakistani businessman Uzair Gadit, with a focus on getting around the excessive internet restrictions such as the Great Firewall of China. Being based in Hong

Kong means that is unclear to what extent China can interfere with the service and the infrastructure. In 2017, the no logs policy of PureVPN came under question when the FBI homed in on a cyberstalker whose computers had been seized after accusations of cyberbullying and hacking. The law enforcement agency found that the individual used PureVPN to hide their tracks, and were able to access information from PureVPN to confirm email services accessed, IP addresses, and accounts on other sites. However, since the computer was seized, PureVPN could have possibly confirm suspicions of the law enforcement workers, by staying within the bounds of its no logging policy. Since scrutiny for privacy is intense, PureVPN has since responded aggressively to build user confidence in its no logging policy.

On August 2, 2021, KPMG published its second audit of the no long policy of the service, and confirmed that PureVPN does not maintain any personally identifiable user information, such as traffic monitoring, timestamps of connections, assigned VPN addresses, or original IP addresses. What is different about this audit is that it was the second audit as part of an “always-on” audit policy, something that PureVPN is a pioneer in. What this means is that KPMG can audit PureVPN at any time without prior notice, as against the typical process which involves both the service provider and the audit company mutually deciding on a timeline for the audit.

With 2000 servers in 140 countries, PureVPN has the largest global network of countries available. Additionally 87 of these countries have virtual servers, which make it appear that the

servers actually are in another country. There is support for 10 simultaneous connections, but do note that the connection is capped at 10 Gbps, which should be sufficient for most users. PureVPN does not offer its own VPN servers, and you have to use third

party DNS servers. The service is available on all major operating systems, with plugins for Chrome and Firefox. The price is on the higher side to comparable services. Users can purchase the service using credit card, GPay and PayPal. There are two cryptocurrencies supported, Ethereum and Bitcoin.

When it comes to speeds, PureVPN consistently offers great speeds across all its various servers in different countries. As such, the speeds do not fall off significantly even when connecting to distant servers. There was minimal reduction in speeds for streaming, and even though the torrenting speeds were reduced considerably, PureVPN comes in third behind NordVPN and ExpressVPN when it comes to torrent speeds. PureVPN strangely does not yet support the Wireguard protocol, which is the fastest yet and suitable for streaming purposes. If PureVPN updates its service to support this protocol, then the speeds stand to improve considerably. Users can switch between TCP and UDP variants of the OpenVPN protocol, with the former geared towards reliability and the latter towards speed. The third option, IKEv2 can offer even more speed than OpenVPN UDP.

Surfshark



As you can see, Surfshark comes up ahead of all the other services by a wide margin, for its low RAM usage, high

speed connections, reasonable pricing and support of a large number of payment modes. The only place where Surfshark is a bit lacking is the privacy front, even though it is one of the few VPN services that provides both a warrant canary and a transparency report. It is based in the Netherlands which is part of the Nine Eyes Alliance, and it does not support dedicated IP addresses. However, Surfshark does allow users to connect to fixed IP address servers, but these are shared among multiple users, which is actually a benefit as downstream services cannot track the user through their IP addresses. So if you need a fixed IP address, you can actually use

